“My boss will always find fault with me.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

A critical parent, teacher, or earlier boss can train us to scan every authority figure for disapproval. At work, a brief tone or a correction can feel like proof that we are in trouble. If we have actually worked under harsh managers, we may expect it everywhere.

What Scripture teaches

Paul says, “Whatever you do, work at it with your whole being, for the Lord and not for men,” and “Serve with good will, as to the Lord and not to men, because you know that the Lord will reward each one for whatever good he does.” Our final evaluator is not our manager. Proverbs says, “A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger.” And “If it is possible on your part, live at peace with everyone.” We take feedback seriously without letting criticism define us. Some bosses are unfair, and then boundaries, documentation, and wise counsel may be needed.

> *“Whatever you do, work at it with your whole being, for the Lord and not for men”* (Colossians 3:23).

Also see

> “Serve with good will, as to the Lord and not to men, because you know that the Lord will reward each one for whatever good he does, whether he is slave or free” (Ephesians 6:7–8).

> “A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger” (Proverbs 15:1).

> “If it is possible on your part, live at peace with everyone” (Romans 12:18).

> “For He knows our frame; He is mindful that we are dust” (Psalm 103:14).

Common self-statements

- No matter what I do, they will criticize me.
- Every email from my boss is a warning.
- I am always one mistake from trouble.
- They have it in for me.
- I cannot do anything right.
- I dread every meeting.

Common logical errors

- Mind reading: Assuming my boss’s negative intent.
- Overgeneralizing: Treating one correction as constant fault-finding.
- Mental filter: Focusing on criticism and missing positive feedback.
- Personalization: Taking neutral comments as personal attacks.

Challenging questions

- What has my boss actually said or done, as opposed to what I assume?
- Have I received any praise or neutral feedback that I discounted?

- Whom did I first expect to find fault with me?
- Is the feedback accurate, and what can I learn from it?
- If the boss really is unfair, what steps are wise?
- Whom do I ultimately work for?

Truth summary

> I can work wholeheartedly for the Lord and receive feedback without being crushed by it. I can distinguish fair critique from my fear. If the treatment really is unfair, I can respond with wisdom, boundaries, and help.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Occupation/Job/Work
- Fear
- Anxiety/Worry
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Wisdom

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Unemployment
- Anxiety/Worry/Fear

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Voice of Truth — Casting Crowns
Test accusing or frightening messages against God's truth.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "My boss will always find fault with me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My boss will always find fault with me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What has my boss actually said?
- ☐ What positive feedback have I received?
- ☐ Whom do I expect to criticize me?
- ☐ What can I learn?
- ☐ What if it is unfair?
- ☐ Whom do I work for?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I work for the Lord first.
- ☐ Feedback is information, not a verdict.
- ☐ A gentle answer turns away wrath.
- ☐ God knows I am dust and has compassion.
- ☐ I can seek wise counsel.
- ☐ I am not defined by my boss's opinion.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Colossians 3:23
  "Whatever you do, work at it with your whole being, for the Lord and not for men."
- ☐ Proverbs 15:1
  "A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger."
- ☐ Psalm 103:14
  "For He knows our frame; He is mindful that we are dust."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Facts at work: Each day, write one factual piece of feedback and one thing that went well.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Colossians 3:23 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I work for the Lord first, so my boss's opinion does not define me.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Occupation/Job/Work" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Collect the facts. Write down actual comments from your boss for two weeks.
- [ ] Ask for clarity. Request a short meeting about expectations.
- [ ] Receive one correction. Respond calmly, "Thank you, I will work on that."
- [ ] Seek counsel. If treatment seems unfair, talk to HR or a wise adviser.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My boss will always find fault with me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Facts, not fear
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My boss will always find fault with me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I work for You first. Calm my fear of criticism, help me learn from fair feedback, and give me wisdom when treatment is unfair. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.